A Boundary Case in a Static Signaling Model

Referee Report

July 13, 2026

Contents

Referee Report **1**

Overall assessment . . . 1

Recommendation and main grounds . . . 1

Issues that could prevent publication . . . 1

Other major issues . . . 2

Is the argument convincing? . . . 2

Detailed Comments (1) . . . 2

Editing comments **3**

Editing assessment . . . 3

Highest-return editing revisions . . . 3

Section-by-section reader audit . . . 3

Terminology, definitions, and notation . . . 4

Tables and figures as writing . . . 4

Mechanics and copyedit inventory . . . 4

Style and writing improvements . . . 5

Detailed Editing Comments (1) . . . 5

Revision plan **6**

How to use this plan . . . 6

P0 — essential before submission . . . 7

P2 — copyediting and optional polish . . . 7

Referee Report

Overall assessment

The synthetic paper isolates a clear comparative-static mechanism, but its global uniqueness conclusion is not supported at the equality boundary.

The main strengths worth preserving are:

- The model is concise and the comparative-static object is easy to reconstruct.

Recommendation and main grounds

Recommendation: Not assessed

Without a specified venue or tier, no publication recommendation is assessed. Independently of fit, the headline proposition requires correction, and the current design can support the repair.

The assessment would improve with these revisions:

- State a tie-breaking rule or weaken the proposition at the equality boundary.

Issues that could prevent publication

1. The headline uniqueness result includes an unresolved boundary case

The paper presents a unique prediction on a domain that permits two optimal actions.

This can be corrected within the current design.

What would change the assessment: Revise the proposition, proof, and comparative-static language consistently at the equality boundary.

Other major issues

No other major substantive issues were identified.

Is the argument convincing?

The mechanism is clear away from the boundary, but the strict global conclusion is not convincing until the equality case is handled.

Detailed Comments (1)

1. Section 3: The global uniqueness claim fails at the equality boundary

Issue: The proposition asserts strict uniqueness although the stated payoff permits a tie.

Relevant text:

> The equilibrium action is unique for every parameter value.

Concern: At equality both actions maximize payoff, so the model supports a set-valued prediction. The proposition and comparative-static summary currently state a stronger global conclusion. No tie-breaking rule or boundary restriction appears in the supplied manuscript.

Suggestions: Add a tie-breaking rule or state a set-valued equilibrium at the boundary. Align Proposition 1, its proof, and the comparative static.

Editing comments

Editing assessment

The synthetic manuscript is concise and readable. One objective subject-verb agreement error requires correction; no broader prose problem is present.

Paper-specific lens: Concise formal-theory paper with a proposition and boundary case.

Strengths to preserve

- The synthetic manuscript states its model and proposition compactly.

Highest-return editing revisions

1. **The proposition summary has a subject-verb agreement error.** Replace “characterize” with “characterizes.”

Section-by-section reader audit

Complete synthetic manuscript

Current job. State the model, proposition, and boundary prediction.

What works. The economic object and boundary case are easy to locate.

Reader friction. One subject-verb agreement error interrupts the proposition summary.

Revision direction. Correct the verb while preserving the concise structure.

Related comments. Editing comment 1: The proposition summary has a subject-verb agreement error

Terminology, definitions, and notation

The fixture uses its equilibrium and boundary terminology consistently. No notation variant requires harmonization.

equilibrium action

Status. consistent

Preferred form. equilibrium action

Variants checked. equilibrium action

Locations checked. Complete synthetic manuscript

Related comments. —

Tables and figures as writing

The synthetic fixture contains no tables or figures, so no exhibit-writing issue is applicable.

Mechanics and copyedit inventory

1. Grammar

- **Section 3, paragraph 2:** Replace “The proposition characterize the model’s comparative static.” with “The proposition characterizes the model’s comparative static.”

See editing comment 1: The proposition summary has a subject-verb agreement error for the full explanation and revision request.

Why it matters: The sentence states the paper’s main proposition, making the agreement error unusually visible.

The singular grammatical subject is visible in the source and rendered fixture.

Style and writing improvements

No additional style revision is recommended beyond the prioritized items above.

Redundancy and repetition

No costly repetition or conflicting duplicate framing was identified.

Detailed Editing Comments (1)

1. Section 3: The proposition summary has a subject-verb agreement error

Issue: A singular subject takes a plural verb in the proposition summary.

Relevant text:

> The proposition characterize the model's comparative static.

Concern: The error appears in the sentence summarizing the main proposition, making a simple copyedit unusually visible. The surrounding prose is otherwise concise and readable. Only this occurrence was found in the supplied manuscript.

Suggestions: Replace "characterize" with "characterizes."

Revision plan

Objective: improve the paper for the intended audience by resolving the verified concerns below.

How to use this plan

Work from P0 to P2. A later review confirms whether each revision resolves the concern by comparing it with the **Done when** condition.

Items keep the numbers they have in the referee report (**Comment N**) and the editing comments (**Editing comment N**), so each number names the same issue in every document. Within a priority level, prerequisites come first and the rest follow the report's order of importance.

Unless an item says otherwise, the current design can support the stated repair. Items that need new evidence or claim narrowing say so explicitly.

P0 — essential before submission

Comment 1: The global uniqueness claim fails at the equality boundary

- **Severity:** critical
- □ **Action:** Add a tie-breaking rule or state a set-valued equilibrium at the boundary. Align Proposition 1, its proof, and the comparative static.
- **Payoff:** Preempts a direct logical objection to the headline proposition.
- **Done when:** Proposition 1 and its proof either supply a tie-breaking rule or state set-valued equilibrium at equality, and the comparative-static summary uses the same boundary qualification.
- **Effort:** hours
- **Dependencies:** None

P2 — copyediting and optional polish

Editing comment 1: The proposition summary has a subject-verb agreement error

- **Severity:** minor
- □ **Action:** Replace “characterize” with “characterizes.”
- **Payoff:** Removes an objective grammar error from the proposition summary.
- **Done when:** The proposition summary uses ’characterizes’ with the singular subject and no duplicate occurrence remains.
- **Effort:** hours
- **Dependencies:** None